Shivangi Ambardar

Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
sambar3@illinois.edu · 608-346-5404 · shivangiambardar.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *Expected 2027*
Dissertation Committee: Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair), Lena Song (Co-Chair), Alexander Bartik, Jorge Lemus.

M.S. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024*

B.A. in Quantitative Economics & Mathematics, Beloit College *2021*
Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters).

RESEARCH FIELDS

Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Innovation and Technological Change, Firm Behavior and Market Structure.

RESEARCH

- "Why Didn't Video Kill the Radio Star? Television Entry, Competition, and Adjustment in Radio Markets" (Job Market Paper)
  I study how U.S. radio stations adapted to the arrival of television, using newly assembled station financial records and the FCC's 1948–1952 freeze on television authorizations. Network revenue fell 31.5 percent and local advertising revenue rose 12.5 percent, with no decline in total revenue.
- "Spatial Diffusion of Unions: Historical Evidence from the UK" (with Keitaro Ninomiya)
  We study whether workplace accidents predicted union formation in 19th-century Britain and whether unionization spread along the railway network, using newly digitized railway records.
- "Special Economic Zones and Local Economic Development in India"
  I use village-level nighttime lights and census data on firms and employment to measure how far the effects of India's Special Economic Zones extend. Gains are concentrated within 5 km of a zone, with higher manufacturing employment and firm counts in nearby villages.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Pricing the Airwaves: Television Entry and Radio Advertising Rates"
- "Market Size, Competition, and Television Entry: Evidence from the FCC Freeze"
- "Technological Disruption and the Geography of Firm Entry: Evidence from Radio and Television"

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024–Present*
- Built firm-level panel datasets (~29,000 observations) from unstructured historical financial reports using automated Python pipelines (Azure Document Intelligence, LLM APIs), cutting manual processing by over 80%.
- Ran relevant econometric analyses in Stata (DiD, IV, panel regressions).
- Led three undergraduate research assistants across project workstreams, including digitizing new data and running validation checks on raw data.

Economist / Consultant, New York State Attorney General's Office *2025*
- Retained with Lena Song to independently verify a quasi-experimental cost-benefit analysis of algorithmic content regulation affecting 500,000+ New York minors, assessing its methodology and the calibration of treatment effects from RCTs to state demographics and platform heterogeneity.
- Verified impact projections that were incorporated into official regulatory documents.
- Presented findings and risk analysis to senior Attorney General's Office leadership and non-technical stakeholders.

Data Analytics Intern, PepsiCo, Consumer Insights *2023*

- Modeled consumer purchasing patterns and built market-share forecasts across a national salty snack portfolio.
- Estimated demand elasticities for PepsiCo and rival product lines to identify pricing opportunities and risks.
- Maintained analytical databases and produced executive-ready reports on market trends and strategic implications.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2022–Present*

- Head Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) — Fall 2023–Present
- Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) — Spring 2023 (head TA in training)
- Assistant Instructor, Microeconomics Theory (ECON 500), M.S. in Policy Economics (MSPE) — Fall 2022

Named to the List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent (6 semesters).[1]

Beloit College *2018–2021*

Teaching Assistant; managed office hours for the following courses:

- Principles of Economics — SP2020 (2 sections), FA2019, SP2019, FA2018, SP2018
- Economic Theory: Microeconomics — SP2020, FA2019, SP2019
- Seminar: Energy and Environmental Economics — SP2020, FA2020
- Quantitative Methods — FA2019, FA2020, SP2021
- Game Theory — FA2019
- Sustainable Agricultural Management — SP2019

HONORS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

1. Bridge to BCG, Boston Consulting Group — *2026, Boston Consulting Group*
2. Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award ($5,000) — *2025, University of Illinois*
3. Morris & Sally Kleiner Labor Economics Prize ($3,000) — *2023, University of Illinois*
4. Albert R. Topps Economics Award — *2021, Beloit College*
5. McAllister Award — *2019, Beloit College*
6. Alexander Award — *2018, Beloit College*
7. Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters) — *2017–2021, Beloit College*

PRESENTATIONS

1. Applied Microeconomics Research Seminar, University of Illinois (8 presentations).
2. "AI-Assisted Digitization of Archival Records," lightning talk, University of Illinois workshop (2026).

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Secretary, Illini Glider Club. FAA private glider pilot certificate (in progress).
Member, Students Advising on Graduate Education (SAGE), University of Illinois (2026).
Reviewer, Midwest International Economic Development Conference (2025).

REFERENCES

Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair)
IBE Distinguished Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
danber@illinois.edu

Lena Song (Co-Chair)
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
lenasong@illinois.edu

Alexander Bartik
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
abartik@illinois.edu

Jorge Lemus
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
jalemus@illinois.edu

[1]The University of Illinois has since discontinued the List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent; the recognition was received in every eligible semester it was offered.